Lesson 37

THE RESURRECTION OF THE BODY

(adapted from the Life in the Spirit Study Bible)

Aim: To teach the believers the biblical teaching of the Resurrection of the body.

Introduction:

"The bodily resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead is the crowning proof of Christianity. If the resurrection did not take place, then Christianity is a false religion. If it did take place, then Christ is God and the Christian faith is absolute truth."—Henry Morris

The resurrection of the body is an essential doctrine in Scripture. It refers to God raising a human body from the dead and reuniting it with the person's soul and spirit, from which at death it was separated during the intermediate state.

I. The Bible reveals at least 3 reasons why the resurrection of the body is necessary.

1. The body is essential to the total human personality, humans are incomplete without a body. Thus, the redemption Christ offers applies to the whole person, including the body - Romans 8:18-25.

2. The body is the temple of the Holy Spirit.

1 Corinthians 6: 19 19It will become once more a temple of the Spirit at the resurrection.

3. To undo the result of sin at all levels, humanity's final enemy (death of the body) Must be conquered through the resurrection .

1 Corinthians 15:26 "The last enemy to be destroyed is death."

II. Both the Old Testament and New Testament teach the future bodily resurrection.

Old Testament

1. Genesis 22:1-14- Abraham and Isaac Story

2. Psalm 16:10- David's confession

3. Job 19:25-27 Job's open vision

New Testament

with Hebrews 11: 17-19

with Acts 2:24-25

with 1 Corinthians 15:22-23

III. Our bodily resurrection is guaranteed by the fact of Christ's resurrection

Matthew 28:6 "He is not here; he has risen, just as he said. Come and see the place where he lay."

The Resurrection of Jesus is one of the central truths of the gospel. 1 Cor. 15:1-8

What is the importance of Christ's resurrection to those who believe in Him?

1. It proves He is the Son of God. John 10:17-18, Romans 1:4

2. It guarantees the efficacy of His redemptive death. Ro. 6:4, 1Co. 15:17

3. It verifies the truth of the Scripture. Ps. 16:10, Acts 2:31

4. It is proof of the future judgement on the wicked. Acts 17: 30-31

5. It is the foundation of Christ's gift of the Holy Spirit and spiritual life to His people. John 20:22, Romans 5:10, 1 Co. 15:45 and for His heavenly ministry Of intercession for the believer (Hebrews 7:23- 28)

6. It assures believers of their future heavenly inheritance. (1 Peter 1:3-4) And of their resurrection or translation when the Lord returns (Jn. 14:3)

7. It makes available the presence of Christ and His power over sin in our everyday experience (Gal. 2:20, Eph. 1:18-20).

IV. In general terms, the believer's resurrected body will be like the Lord's own resurrected body.

Philippians 3:20-21 *"But our citizenship is in heaven. And we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ, who, by the power that enables him to bring everything under his control, will transform our lowly bodies so that they will be like his glorious body."*

1. A body possessing continuity and identity with the body of this life and therefore Recognizable (Luke 16:19-31)

2. A body changed into heavenly body adopted for the new heaven and new earth. 1 Co. 15:42-44,47-48, Rev. 21:1

4. An imperishable body, free from decay and death. (1 Co. 15:42)

5. A glorified body like Christ's. 1Co. 15:43, Phil. 3:20-21

6. A powerful body not subject to disease and weakness (1Co. 15:43)

7. A spiritual (not natural, but supernatural) body, not bound by laws of nature. Luke 24:31

8. A body capable of eating and drinking. Luke 24:36:48

V. When believers receive their new bodies, they put on immortality. 1 Co. 15:53

Scripture indicates at least 3 purposes for this;

1. So that believers may become all that God intended for humans at creation. 1 Co. 2:9-10

2. So that believers may come to know God in the full way. He wants them to know Him. John 17:3

3. So that God may express His love to His children as He desires.

John 3:16

Eph. 2:7

1John 4:8-16

VI. Jesus speaks of a resurrection of life for the believer and a resurrection of judgement for the wicked.

John 5:28-29

"Do not be amazed at this, for a time is coming when all who are in their graves will hear his voice and come out-those who have done good will rise to live, and those who have done evil will rise to be condemned."